



MINISTRY OF EDUCATION
SECONDARY SCHOOL CAREER PATHWAYS AND SUBJECT COMBINATIONS - AN
EXTRACT FROM THE 2023 FINAL AND APPROVED CURRICULUM FRAMEWORK
By Gershom Mumba

A. ORDINARY LEVEL (O' LEVEL)

1. NATURAL SCIENCES (NS)

	SUBJECT	NUMBER OF HOURS PER WEEK	NUMBER OF PERIODS PER WEEK
	<u>COMPULSORY SUBJECTS</u>		
1	ENGLISH LANGUAGE	4 Hours	6
2	MATHEMATICS	4 Hours	6
3	BIOLOGY	4 Hours	6
4	CHEMISTRY	4 Hours	6
5	PHYSICS	4 Hours	6
6	CIVIC EDUCATION	3hrs 20min	5
7	INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)	3hrs 20min	5
	TOTAL	26 HOURS	40

2. AGRICULTURAL SCIENCE (AS)

	SUBJECT	NUMBER OF HOURS PER WEEK	NUMBER OF PERIODS PER WEEK
	<u>COMPULSORY SUBJECTS</u>		
1	ENGLISH LANGUAGE	4 Hours	6
2	MATHEMATICS	4 Hours	6
3	CIVIC EDUCATION	3hrs 20min	5
4	AGRICULTURAL SCIENCE (<i>Core Subject</i>)	8 hours	12
4	CHEMISTRY	4 Hours	6
5	PHYSICS	4 Hours	6
7	INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)	3hrs 20min	5
	TOTAL	30 hrs, 40 min	46

3. TECHNOLOGY (TECH)

	SUBJECT	NUMBER OF HOURS PER WEEK	NUMBER OF PERIODS PER WEEK
	<u>COMPULSORY SUBJECTS</u>		
1	ENGLISH LANGUAGE	4 Hours	6
2	MATHEMATICS	4 Hours	6
3	CIVIC EDUCATION	3hrs 20min	5
4	DESIGN AND TECHNOLOGY/COMPUTER SCIENCE (<i>Core Subject</i>)	8 hours	12
4	CHEMISTRY	4 Hours	6
5	PHYSICS	4 Hours	6
7	INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)	3hrs 20min	5
	TOTAL	30 hrs, 40 min	46

4. HOME ECONOMICS AND HOSPITALITY (HEH)

	SUBJECT	NUMBER OF HOURS PER WEEK	NUMBER OF PERIODS PER WEEK
1	ENGLISH LANGUAGE	4 Hours	6
2	MATHEMATICS	4 Hours	6
3	CIVIC EDUCATION	3hrs 20min	5
4	FASHION AND FABRICS/FOOD AND NUTRITION/HOME MANAGEMENT (<i>Core Subject</i>)	8 hours	12
5	BIOLOGY	4 Hours	6
6	INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)	3hrs 20min	5
7	CHEMISTRY/TRAVEL AND TOURISM	3hrs 20min/8 Hrs	5/12
8	FRENCH/CHINESE/PORTUGUESE/SWAHILI	3hrs 20min	5
	TOTAL		

5. SOCIAL SCIENCES (SS)

	SUBJECT	NUMBER OF HOURS PER WEEK	NUMBER OF PERIODS PER WEEK
	<u>COMPULSORY SUBJECTS</u>		
1	ENGLISH LANGUAGE	4 Hours	6
2	MATHEMATICS	4 Hours	6
3	CIVIC EDUCATION	3hrs 20min	5
4	GEOGRAPHY/HISTORY/RE (<i>Core Subject</i>)	3hrs 20min	5
5	INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)	3hrs 20min	5
	<u>OPTIONAL SUBJECTS – Choose one from each category below</u>		
7	LIT IN ENG/ZAM LANG/LIT IN ZAM LANG/FRENCH/CHINESE/PORTUGUESE/SWAHILI	3hrs 20min	5
8	BIOLOGY/CHEMISTRY/PHYSICS	4 Hours	6
	TOTAL	25 hrs, 20 min	38

6. BUSINESS STUDIES AND FINANCE (BSF)

	SUBJECT	NUMBER OF HOURS PER WEEK	NUMBER OF PERIODS PER WEEK
	<u>COMPULSORY SUBJECTS</u>		
1	ENGLISH LANGUAGE	4 Hours	6
2	MATHEMATICS	4 Hours	6
3	CIVIC EDUCATION	3hrs 20min	5
4	PRINCIPLES OF ACCOUNTS (<i>Core Subject</i>)	3hrs 20min	5
5	COMMERCE (<i>Core Subject</i>)	3hrs 20min	5
6	INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)	3hrs 20min	5
	<u>OPTIONAL SUBJECTS – Choose any one</u>		
7	BIOLOGY/CHEMISTRY/PHYSICS	4 Hours	6
	TOTAL	25 hrs, 20 min	38

7. PERFORMING AND CREATIVE ARTS (PCA)

	SUBJECT	NUMBER OF HOURS PER WEEK	NUMBER OF PERIODS PER WEEK
	<u>COMPULSORY SUBJECTS</u>		
1	ENGLISH LANGUAGE	4 Hours	6
2	MATHEMATICS	4 Hours	6
3	CIVIC EDUCATION	3hrs 20min	5
4	ART AND DESIGN/MUSIC (<i>Core Subject</i>)	8 hours	12
5	ZAMBIAN LANGUAGE	3hrs 20min	5
6	INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)	3hrs 20min	5
	<u>OPTIONAL SUBJECTS – Choose any one</u>		
7	LIT IN ENGLISH/LIT IN ZAMBIAN LANGUAGES	3hrs 20min	5
	TOTAL	29 hrs, 20 min	44

8. PHYSICAL EDUCATION AND SPORTS (PES)

	SUBJECT	NUMBER OF HOURS PER WEEK	NUMBER OF PERIODS PER WEEK
	COMPULSORY SUBJECTS		
1	ENGLISH LANGUAGE	4 Hours	6
2	MATHEMATICS	4 Hours	6
3	CIVIC EDUCATION	3hrs 20min	5
4	BIOLOGY	4 Hours	6
5	PHYSICAL EDUCATION (<i>Core Subject</i>)	8 Hours	12
6	INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)	3hrs 20min	5
7	OPTIONAL SUBJECTS – Choose one from any category below		
(a)	GEOGRAPHY/HISTORY/RE	3hrs 20min	5
(b)	CHEMISTRY/PHYSICS	4 Hours	6
	TOTAL	25 hrs, 20 min	38

Take note of the following on Ordinary Level (O' Level) Secondary Education System

- (i) Ordinary Secondary School Level shall run from Form 1 to 4.
- (ii) The O' Level Secondary School Education System shall have **Eight (8) Career Pathways** as follows: Natural Sciences , Agricultural Science, Technology, Home Economics and Hospitality, Social Sciences, Business Studies and Finance, Performing and Creative Arts and Physical Education and Sports.
- (iii) Schools shall offer specialized O' Level and A' Level pathways **depending on the guidelines that shall be provided, based on the availability of staff, infrastructure and equipment.**
- (iv) A period for a lesson, under the Ordinary Secondary School Level shall be **40 minutes per period.**
- (v) Each career pathway at O' Level shall have a **maximum of 7 subjects, except for the Home Economics and Hospitality (HEH) pathway which may have up to 8 subjects.**
- (vi) Learners at Ordinary Secondary School Level shall take **a minimum of 6 and maximum of 7 subjects, except for those in the HEH career pathway who may take up to a maximum of 8 subjects.**
- (vii) Learners taking Practical Subjects such as Information and Communication Technology, Computer Science, Fashion and Fabrics, Food and Nutrition, Travel and Tourism, Home Management, Agricultural Science, Design and Technology, Art and Design, Music, and Physical Education, shall be given an option to sit for Trade Test Certificate Examinations offered by TEVETA.
- (viii) Financial literacy and Entrepreneurship has been integrated in carrier subjects and shall be offered to ALL learners.

B. ADVANCE LEVEL (A' LEVEL)

Take note of the following on Advanced Level (A' Level) Secondary Education System

- (i) Advanced Secondary School Level shall run from Form 5 to 6.

- (ii) *The A' Level Secondary School Education System shall have **Five (5) Career Pathways** as follows: STEM, Social Sciences and Languages, Performing and Creative Arts. Business Studies and Sports Science.*
- (iii) *Entry point for candidates into A Level shall be a School Certificate or its equivalent, with 3 credits or better, in the area of specialization.*
- (iv) *In each A' Level career pathway, learners shall take a minimum of 3 and maximum of 4 subjects.*
- (v) *Teachers to handle A' Levels shall have a minimum of a bachelors' degree in that area of specialization/teaching area.*

ADVANCED LEVEL CAREER PATHWAYS

Guidance shall be provided on the subject combination, based on the pathway.

1. SCIENCE, TECHNOLOGY, ENGINEERING AND MATHEMATICS (STEM)

- (i) **Biology**
- (ii) **Physics**
- (iii) **Chemistry**
- (iv) **Agricultural Science**
- (v) **Computer Science**
- (vi) **Mathematics**
- (vii) **Design and Technology**
- (viii) **Fashion and Fabrics**
- (ix) **Food and Nutrition**
- (x) **Hospitality Management**
- (xi) **Travel and Tourism**

2. SOCIAL SCIENCES AND LANGUAGES

- (i) **Geography**
- (ii) **Civic Education**
- (iii) **History**
- (iv) **Religious Education**
- (v) **English Language**
- (vi) **Literature in English**
- (vii) **Zambian Language**
- (viii) **French/Chinese/Portuguese/Swahili**

3. BUSINESS STUDIES

- (i) **Economics**
- (ii) **Accounting**
- (iii) **Commerce**

4. SPORTS SCIENCE

- (i) **Physical Education**

5. PERFORMING AND CREATIVE ARTS

- (i) **Art and Design**
- (ii) **Music**